

STUDY 1

1ST SUNDAY AFTER TRINITY, JUNE 7 2026

THEME: Rooted and Fruitful: Growing in Christian Character

SUB-THEME: The Soil of the Heart

TOPIC: Preparing the Heart to Receive God's Word

TEXT: Matthew 13:3-9

AIMS:

- i. To help members examine what kind of "soil" their hearts currently represent.
- ii. To identify obstacles that prevent the Word of God from taking root and producing fruit.
- iii. To encourage deliberate cultivation of a receptive heart through prayer and obedience.

INTRODUCTION

Every sermon heard, every scripture read, falls upon a heart that is either prepared or unprepared to receive it. In the Parable of the Sower, Jesus describes four kinds of ground, only one of which produces a lasting harvest (Mat 13:3-9). James reminds believers to receive the implanted word with meekness, for it alone is able to save their souls (Jas 1:21). The condition of the heart, therefore, determines whether the Word merely passes through a life or transforms it permanently.

STUDY GUIDE

1. Identify the four types of soil in Matthew 13:3-9 and describe a modern equivalent of each.
2. Read Hosea 10:12. What does it mean to "break up the fallow ground" of one's heart?
3. What practical habits (e.g., prayer, meditation, fellowship) help soften a hardened heart over time?
4. Discuss how cares of this world (referenced in Mrk 4:19) can choke spiritual growth even in believers who once received the Word gladly.

CONCLUSION

God is not merely scattering seed carelessly; He desires a harvest. Each member must therefore take responsibility for the condition of their own heart, removing stones, thorns, and hardness that hinder fruitfulness.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT: A heart that resists tilling will never know the joy of harvest.

MEMORY VERSE: Matthew 13:8 — But the seed that fell on good soil produced a harvest, some yielding a hundred, some sixty, some thirty times what was sown.

STUDY 2

2ND SUNDAY AFTER TRINITY, JUNE 14 2026

THEME: Rooted and Fruitful: Growing in Christian Character

SUB-THEME: Patience in the Process

TOPIC: Growing Without Rushing God's Timing

TEXT: James 5:7-8

AIMS:

- i. To teach that spiritual and personal growth often follows a slow, hidden process.
- ii. To help members resist the temptation to force premature results through impatience.
- iii. To draw encouragement from the farmer's example of waiting for rain.

INTRODUCTION

Modern life trains us to expect instant results, yet the Kingdom of God frequently operates on a different clock. James counsels believers to be patient, comparing them to a farmer who waits for the precious fruit of the earth, enduring both early and latter rains (Jas 5:7-8). Paul similarly encourages the Galatians not to grow weary in well-doing, promising a harvest in due season if they do not give up (Gal 6:9). True growth cannot be manufactured overnight; it must be nurtured over time.

STUDY GUIDE

- i. What does the farmer's patience in James 5:7 teach about the nature of spiritual maturity?
- ii. Read Ecclesiastes 3:1-2. How does recognising "a time for every purpose" help reduce anxious striving?
- iii. Share an area of your life where you are currently tempted to rush a process that requires patience.

CONCLUSION

The believer who learns to wait on God's timing rather than forcing outcomes will discover a steadier, more enduring fruitfulness. Patience is not passive; it is active trust in a faithful Husbandman.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT: Rushed fruit rarely ripens well.

MEMORY VERSE: James 5:8 — You too, be patient and strengthen your hearts, for the coming of the Lord draws near.

STUDY 3

3RD SUNDAY AFTER TRINITY, JUNE 21 2026

THEME: Rooted and Fruitful: Growing in Christian Character

SUB-THEME: Pruning for Greater Fruit

TOPIC: Embracing Correction and Discipline

TEXT: Jn 15:1-2, Heb 12:11

AIMS:

- i. To help members understand pruning as an act of love rather than punishment.
- ii. To examine how correction, though painful, produces greater fruitfulness afterward.

INTRODUCTION

No gardener leaves a fruitful branch untouched; it is pruned precisely because it bears fruit, so that it may bear even more (Jn 15:2). The writer of Hebrews acknowledges that no discipline seems pleasant at the time, but painful though it is, it later yields a peaceable harvest of righteousness for those trained by it (Heb 12:11). To grow in Christian character, therefore, believers must learn to welcome correction rather than resent it.

STUDY GUIDE

- What does it mean practically for God to "prune" a believer's life, according to John 15:1-2?
- Read Proverbs 3:11-12. Why does the writer link discipline directly to love?
- Discuss a time correction from Scripture, a mentor, or Xzq 9:3 shaped your character in ways you did not initially welcome.

CONCLUSION

Pruning is uncomfortable but never wasteful in the hand of a skilled Gardener. Believers who submit to correction position themselves for a fruitfulness they could not otherwise attain.

MEMORY VERSE TO LEARN: John 15:2 — Every branch that bears no fruit He removes, and every branch that bears fruit He trims clean so it may bear even more.

STUDY 4

4TH SUNDAY AFTER TRINITY, JUNE 28 2026

THEME: Rooted and Fruitful: Growing in Christian Character

SUB-THEME: Deep Roots, Steady Growth

TOPIC: Staying Anchored When Storms Come

TEXT: Jer 17:7-8, Col 2:6-7

AIMS:

- i. To show that visible fruitfulness depends on unseen, deep-rooted trust in God.
- ii. To equip members with practical ways to strengthen their spiritual roots before crisis strikes.
- iii. To encourage steadfastness rooted in Christ rather than shifting circumstances.

INTRODUCTION

A tree planted by the waters does not panic when heat comes, because its roots reach deep enough to draw what it needs even in drought (Jer 17:7-8). Paul instructs the Colossian church to be rooted and built up in Christ, established in the faith just as they were taught (Col 2:6-7). Character that withstands pressure is rarely built during the storm itself; it is formed quietly, beforehand, in seasons of ordinary faithfulness.

STUDY GUIDE

1. Contrast the imagery of Jeremiah 17:5-6 with 17:7-8. What distinguishes the cursed man from the blessed one?
2. Read Psalm 1:3. What daily practices help a believer's "roots" reach deeper into God's Word?
3. Discuss a season of pressure in your own life. Looking back, what rootedness (or lack of it) shaped how you responded?

CONCLUSION

Roots are unseen, yet they determine everything visible above ground. Members are encouraged to invest quietly in their walk with God now, long before the next storm arrives.

MEMORY VERSE: Jeremiah 17:8 — He shall be like a tree planted by the waters, spreading out its roots, unafraid when the heat comes, for its leaves stay green.

STUDY 5

5TH SUNDAY AFTER TRINITY, JULY 5 2026

THEME: Rooted and Fruitful: Growing in Christian Character

SUB-THEME: The Fruit That Remains

TOPIC: Bearing Fruit That Outlasts Us

TEXT: Jn 15:16, Gal 5:22-23

AIMS:

- i. To distinguish between activity that appears fruitful and fruit that genuinely remains.
- ii. To identify the Spirit's fruit as the true evidence of a transformed character.
- iii. To inspire members toward a legacy of fruitfulness beyond their own lifetime.

INTRODUCTION

Jesus told His disciples that He had chosen and appointed them to go and bear fruit — fruit that would remain (Jn 15:16). This enduring fruit is not measured merely by visible achievement but by transformed character, described by Paul as love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control (Gal 5:22-23). A life rooted in Christ ultimately leaves behind more than accomplishments; it leaves behind evidence of His Spirit at work.

STUDY GUIDE

1. What is the difference between fruit that "remains" and activity that merely looks impressive in the moment?
2. Read 2 Peter 1:5-8. How does this passage describe fruit as something added to, not merely produced once?
3. Which aspect of the fruit of the Spirit (Gal 5:22-23) do you sense needs the most deliberate cultivation in your life right now?

CONCLUSION

The truest measure of a fruitful life is not how much was done, but how much of Christ's character remained afterward, both in us and in those we touched.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT: What we build may be forgotten; who we became will remain.

PRAYER POINTS:

- Pray for the Holy Spirit to cultivate genuine, lasting fruit of character in every member.
- Pray against shallow, performance-driven spirituality that seeks recognition over transformation.
- Pray for grace to leave behind a legacy that outlasts our own generation.

MEMORY VERSE: John 15:16 — You did not choose Me, but I chose you and appointed you to go and bear fruit, fruit that will remain.